WHAT IS THE SCHWA?

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the six words at the top out loud. The stressed syllable is shaded with a mark in front of it, and the letter that says the schwa is underlined. Then do the same for the six words underneath: read the word, shade or circle the syllable you say with the most force, underline the schwa letter, and write that letter in the box.

ə
SCHWA

The schwa is the lazy vowel sound you hear in an unstressed syllable: the **a** of about, the **o** of lesson, the **e** of problem. It is a short "uh" that almost disappears. Dictionaries write it as an upside-down e. It is the most common vowel sound in English, and any of the five vowel letters can spell it.

THESE ARE MARKED FOR YOU

		schwa letter
a · 'bout		a
'les · son		o
'prob · lem		e
'pen · cil		i
'cir · cus		u
'so · fa		a

NOW YOU MARK THESE

		schwa letter
wag · on		
ze · bra		
rib · bon		
but · ton		
a · way		
car · rot		

Say it louder: the schwa never sits in the strong syllable. Find the strong syllable first, then look at the other one.

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WHAT IS THE SCHWA? ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

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NOW YOU MARK THESE

		schwa letter
'wag · on		o
'ze · bra		a
'rib · bon		o
'but · ton		o
a · 'way		a
'car · rot		o

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